Japan Portfolio Brief — Thursday, November 5, 2026

Covers the Nov 4 close through the Nov 5 close (Tokyo and Seoul sessions complete). **Data-quality warning (continuing):** research ran on search snippets only. kabutan, kabuyoho, TDnet, DART, MOF, BoJ, company IR, Korea Times and Seoul Economic Daily were not fetchable (DNS blocked), so no primary document was opened. "QUIET" means "nothing found," not "confirmed quiet." Earnings dates are mostly aggregator-sourced. Check TDnet/DART before acting on any single-name call.

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1. Top of the stack

1. The AI-trade unwind deepens: KOSPI -5.28%, Nikkei -1.79%, Topix up. KOSPI closed at **5,383.80 (-5.28%)**, its first close under 5,400 in about seven months, with Samsung Electronics -7.57% and SK hynix -9.46%; KOSDAQ fell 5.11% to 678.41 and foreigners sold roughly ₩3.4tn (reports range ₩2.4–3.8tn) (Seoul Economic Daily, Korea Times). The Nikkei closed **-1.79% at 61,077.90** while the **Topix rose 1.16% to 3,940.39** (newsonjapan; other aggregators show -2.15% to -2.22% for the Nikkei, likely earlier snapshots). It was a tech-only selloff: Advantest -14.7%, Tokyo Electron -9.4% (Reuters via The Star), with Furukawa Electric and Sumco down roughly 15–18% (single-source), and rotation into the broader market. The trigger remains the US midterm result and AI data-center regulation fears. Exposed holdings: SoftBank, RS Technologies, MegaChips, Sanken, Appier, SK Inc, Samsung C&T, Hyosung/LS (AI-power).

2. SoftBank Group (9984): China blocks the $5.4bn ABB Robotics deal. The FT reported and ABB confirmed on Nov 5 that Chinese regulators blocked the takeover; shares fell about 5–7% alongside the AI selloff (single-source on size, no exact close found) (Japan Times, investinglive). SoftBank may reapply. H1 results are Tue Nov 10 per a German snippet (boerse-global; time unverified). MATTERS, negative: AI beta, OpenAI valuation and leverage, and a blocked robotics leg into the print.

3. Sony (6758) raised guidance — and reported today, not Nov 10. (Correction to yesterday's brief.) H1 operating income was ¥1.0988tn (+42.9%) on sales of ¥6.267tn; FY operating income guidance was raised to ¥1.87tn from ¥1.72tn and net income guidance about 10% to ¥1.33tn (gamebiz, kabutan, schedule). The stock reaction comes Nov 6. MATTERS, positive.

4. LG Chem/LG Corp: LGES share sale mechanics re-confirmed; LG Chem Q3 weak. The Oct 28 board decision: sale of 6,535,939 LGES shares (about ₩2.5tn) through a two-year PRS at a ₩382,500 reference price, disposal window **Nov 27–Dec 24**, taking LG Chem's stake from about 79.4% to about 76.6% (Sateconomy, SBS Biz). A ₩300bn buyback (1.389m shares incl. 142,586 preferred, so 051915 is directly in scope) runs **Dec 1–May 31, 2027** with full cancellation, plus ₩100bn to the year-end dividend (SBS Biz). LG Chem Q3 (today): revenue ₩15.496tn (+34%), operating profit ₩561.2bn (-17.4%), net loss about ₩600bn, petrochemicals -₩175.6bn, oversupply expected to continue (Dealsite, TheElec; consensus comparison not found). MATTERS.

5. Daikin (6367) and Seiko Epson (6724) reported after the close — modest raises. Daikin H1 recurring profit ¥247.1bn (+2.2%), FY recurring guide to ¥417bn from ¥414bn, dividend ¥370 from ¥360 (kabutan). Note an English-language snippet instead cites H1 operating profit about ¥270.8bn and FY operating profit ¥455bn from ¥436bn (Investing.com) — different measure, not contradictory but unreconciled. Seiko Epson H1 net profit ¥44.6bn (2.4x), FY net guide to ¥72bn from ¥69bn (kabutan). Reaction Nov 6.

2. What matters, by theme

Macro, rates, FX

- **BoJ:** policy rate 1.25% (held Oct 30 after the September hike; Takata dissented for 1.5%) (Bloomberg). No Ueda or board remarks dated Nov 4–5 found. No sourced December hike probability; figures of 76–80% in search results date from December 2025 and are stale.

- **JGBs:** 10y about 2.77% on Nov 5 (about 4bp lower), per an undated-snippet Trading Economics page; an undated Finimize item says 2.755% after a soft auction. No 2y/5y/30y yields or Nov 5 auction found. Risk-off flows from the AI selloff and lower oil are consistent with lower yields (inference).
- **Yen:** USD/JPY about 157–158; Finance Minister Katayama's Nov 2 readiness-to-act remarks were shrugged off and no intervention has been reported (FXStreet Nov 2, FXStreet Nov 4). Nov 5 close not found.
- **Bank of Korea:** base rate 3.00%, held Oct 22; surveys expect a November hike to 3.50% (some 3.75%) (KED Global, Seoul Economic Daily). Official meeting date unconfirmed (only a Polymarket reference to about Nov 25). A 5% equity drop complicates a hike. USD/KRW closed at about 1,342 (Korea Times).
- **Korea structure:** no new market-structure news found for Nov 5. A sell-side sidecar was triggered during the KOSPI drop.

Megacaps / tech (Japan)

- **SoftBank (9984), Sony (6758), Daikin (6367), Seiko Epson (6724):** see Section 1.
- **Omron (6645):** H1 Nov 10 (kabuyoho). QUIET.
- **Keyence (6861), Canon (7751):** reported before the window; no new news. NOISE/priced.
- **MegaChips (6875):** H1 Nov 6 (kabuyoho); high beta to the chip selloff. QUIET.
- **Sanken (6707):** H1 Nov 11 (kabuyoho). **Appier (4180):** Q3 Nov 13 (kabuyoho). **Optex (6914):** Q3 Nov 13 (kabuyoho). **Oro (3983):** Dec FY, Q3 Nov 16 (kabuyoho) — correction to earlier assumptions. QUIET.
- **SHIFT (3697):** Aug FY-end; no November catalyst found. **RS Technologies (3445):** date not found (last year Nov 13); exposed to Sumco/AI-chip selloff (inference). QUIET.
- **Valqua (7995):** kabuyoho shows H1 on Nov 4 or "early Nov"; whether it reported is unverified. Check TDnet.
- **NAVER (035420):** Q3 Nov 11, 16:00 (unconfirmed, KnowingAsset). No NAVER-specific move found.

Banks / financials / real estate

- **No stock-specific news found for any bank in the 24h window.** Dates: **MUFG** H1 Nov 13 (kabuyoho); **SMTG** Nov 12 (traders.co.jp); **Resona** Nov 10, aggregator only (japanir); **Kita-Nippon (8551)** Nov 12, 15:00 (traders.co.jp); **8524** Nov 13, 14:00 (kabuyoho); **Japan Post** Nov 13 (carried from prior run, not re-checked). **SMFG/Mizuho** dates unconfirmed (last year Nov 14).
- **Resona (8308):** routine ¥50bn buyback running to Jan 31, 2027 (Aug purchases ¥10.64bn, filing); a Nov 2 treasury-share notice is mentioned but not seen. NOISE.
- **SBI (8473):** record H1 reported Nov 2 (see Nov 4 brief). **Mitsui Fudosan (8801):** H1 "early Nov," likely Nov 5–7 (kabuyoho); real estate rose on the Topix rotation. Fidea, Kyoto FG, Shimizu Bank, TOC, Keisei, Yakult, Shochiku, Tokyotokeiba, Universal Entertainment (latest found: Aug 7 H1, Daiwa IR): QUIET/unverified.

Industrials / autos / small-mid caps

- **Nakayama Steel (5408):** H1 Nov 5 per kabuyoho (TradingView says Nov 10); no verified result. A TipRanks snippet showing H1 operating profit ¥0.91bn (-69.8%) is undated and possibly last year's — do not rely on it. Full-year guide ordinary profit ¥2.0bn (-58%).
- **Ebara Jitsugyo (6328):** Q3 Nov 5 (kabuyoho); no result found. H1 ordinary profit ¥3.87bn was 59.5% of the full-year guide.
- **JR Central (9022):** resolved — Oct 28 H1 ordinary profit ¥425.9bn (+0.1%); FY ordinary forecast raised to ¥715bn from ¥653bn, dividend ¥34 from ¥32 (kabutan). This reconciles last run's conflict (¥715bn is ordinary profit). NOISE.
- **Kubota (6326):** Q3 "early Nov," date unconfirmed (kabuyoho). **Suzuki (7269):** no date found (last year Nov 6); Q1 operating profit ¥158.0bn, FY guide ¥540bn (tanshin). **Honda (7267)** and **Subaru (7270):** Nov 10. **Sumitomo Metal Mining (5713):** Nov 10 (kabuyoho); Q1 net ¥87.9bn, a guide-raise candidate. **Mitsubishi Materials (5711):** Nov 11 (kabuyoho).
- **Hi-Lex (7279):** the 9M tanshin shows 10 newly consolidated companies, sales +40.8% and negative-goodwill-boosted net profit (tanshin); the watchlist blurb is stale. Next: FY results mid-Dec.

- **KH Neochem (4189):** H1 ordinary profit ¥7.45bn (+29%) vs its own ¥4.5bn forecast, FY guide ¥12.6bn unchanged — an upward revision looks likely; Q3 date not found. **Obara (6877):** Q3 operating profit ¥9.68bn (+30%); FY results early/mid Nov, date not found. **Tigers Polymer (4231):** Nov 11, 16:00 (Matsui). **Shibaura Machine, Fudo Tetra, JAPEX, Katakura:** dates not found; QUIET.

Korea names

- **Taekwang Industrial (003240): MATTERS, unresolved.** No EGM request, court filing or tender offer found after the Oct 3 reply deadline; latest dated items are Sep 14 (Trustone to exercise rights "sequentially," EGM call named as an option) (Nate, Bizwatch). DART unreachable, so "nothing found" is weak.
- **LG Chem pref / LG Corp:** see Section 1. LG Corp: no stock-specific news.
- **Samsung C&T (028260):** construction operating profit ₩277bn (+149.5%), order target raised to ₩30.1tn (SBS Biz); consolidated figure still conflicts (about ₩1.14tn vs "near ₩1tn," Sateconomy). Holds Samsung Electronics stake (-7.57% today). Verify on DART.
- **SK Inc (034730):** no new news; ~20% share cancellation due Jan 2027 (Newsis); SK hynix's -9.46% hurts NAV (inference); SK hynix buyback ends Nov 19 (MTN).
- **Hyosung (004800):** Hyosung Heavy Q3 operating profit ₩243.5bn (+10.8%), missed a ~₩290bn broker estimate; record ₩18.9tn backlog; Hyosung Corp ₩175.3bn (+43.9%); Hyosung Chemical swung to a loss (CEOScore). NOISE, mixed. **LS Corp (006260):** LS Electric record North America Q3 revenue (about ₩500bn), backlog about ₩7tn (Specialtimes); AI-power exposure is a selloff risk (inference). QUIET.
- **Misto Holdings (081660):** Acushnet Q3 (Nov 4) sales $649.2m (-1.3%), adj. EBITDA $114.7m (-3.3%), Titleist segment operating profit -15.2%, revenue guide reaffirmed (SEC). Mildly negative; Misto's own Q3 not yet out.
- **ILJIN (015860):** Q3 likely Nov 13–14 (etfshopping). **F&F (383220):** Q3 date likely by Nov 14 (aggregator shows Nov 16, Investing.com KR). **Amorepacific, LG Electronics pref, SK Discovery, Daewon Sanup, Eusu, Motonic, Seoul City Gas, Samyang Tongsang, Ubiquoss:** nothing found; Q3 filing deadline Nov 14. QUIET/unverified.

3. Probably noise

- **Keyence, Canon, JR Central, Amorepacific, LG Electronics Q3:** reported before the window; priced.
- **Resona buyback progress:** routine.
- **Daikin "operating profit ¥270.8bn / FY ¥455bn" snippet:** likely a different profit measure; use the kabutan recurring-profit figures until reconciled.
- **Nakayama TipRanks H1 numbers:** undated, possibly last year's.
- **Sources claiming a >70% December Fed hike probability, and 76–80% December BoJ hike odds:** unverified or stale.
- **Honda "Nexperia exemption / normal by Nov 24":** looks like a re-dated 2025 story.

4. Time-sensitive / positions watch

JGB No. 466 (0.50%, JP1024661QB1) — matured Sun Nov 1; settlement still unverified. A Nagoya Stock Exchange statistics PDF lists 利付国債2年 第466回 (code 04660042) redeeming 2026-11-01 (NSE; seen via snippet, not opened). That suggests No. 466 is a **2-year note** (issued about Nov 2024), not a 10-year; the coupon and the ISIN-to-bond mapping remain unconfirmed and the ISIN itself returned nothing. No MOF or custodian source found on redemption. **Decisions:** (1) confirm with the custodian that proceeds settled; (2) reinvest or hold cash — reference 10y about 2.77%, BoJ December hike risk un-quantified. **`watchlist-japan.md` needs updating once redemption is confirmed;** the line is retained with a flag.

*Calendar (= aggregator/inferred/unconfirmed):**

- Nov 5 (done, reaction Nov 6): Sony, Daikin, Seiko Epson; Nakayama*, Ebara Jitsugyo*
- Nov 5–7: Mitsui Fudosan*, Kubota Q3*, Suzuki*
- Nov 6: MegaChips; US payrolls (not re-verified)

- Nov 10: **SoftBank Group**; Honda; Subaru; Omron; Sumitomo Metal Mining; Resona*
- Nov 11: NAVER* (16:00); Sanken; Mitsubishi Materials; Tigers Polymer (16:00)
- Nov 12: SMTG*; Kita-Nippon 8551 (15:00); RS Technologies* (about Nov 12–13)
- Nov 13: MUFG*; Japan Post*; 8524 (14:00); Appier; Optex; SMFG/Mizuho (Nov 13–14*)
- By Nov 14: Korea Q3 filings (ILJIN, F&F, others)
- Nov 16: Oro Q3
- Nov 19: SK hynix buyback window ends
- Late Nov (date unverified): Bank of Korea meeting
- Nov 27–Dec 24: LGES PRS disposal window; Dec 1: LG Chem buyback starts

Undated-but-live: SoftBank/OpenAI leverage and ABB reapplication; AI-capex and US AI-policy headlines post-midterms; Taekwang–Trustone EGM; December BoJ hike; BoK November hike; yen near 158 with intervention rhetoric.

Identity/watchlist flags:

1. **8551 vs 8524 — still open for the owner.** 8524 = 北洋銀行 (The North Pacific Bank, Hokkaido; closed ¥1,214 Oct 30, kabuyoho); 8551 = 北日本銀行 (The Kita-Nippon Bank, Iwate; +2.81% to ¥2,448 on Oct 29 with no identified news). Coverage follows 8551. Please confirm which is held. Nothing found on either today.
2. **JGB JP1024661QB1:** matured Nov 1; likely a 2-year note (new, snippet-level); settlement unverified.
3. **Date corrections:** Sony H1 was Nov 5 (not Nov 10); Oro is a Dec-FY company, Q3 Nov 16; Japan Post/MUFG dates remain aggregator-only.
4. **Hi-Lex** blurb in the watchlist is stale (large consolidation). No other identity changes confirmed.

5. Follow-up questions to investigate

- **JP1024661QB1:** custodian confirmation of settlement; whether it was a 2-year note; reinvestment plan.
- **SoftBank (9984):** exact Nov 5 close; ABB reapplication path; OpenAI valuation and LTV before Nov 10.
- **Sony / Daikin / Epson:** Nov 6 reaction; Daikin recurring vs operating profit reconciliation (TDnet).
- **Nakayama Steel, Ebara Jitsugyo, Valqua:** actual results (TDnet).
- **Korea:** Nov 5 closes for portfolio names given the 5% index drop; BoK November meeting date and whether a hike survives the selloff.
- **LG Chem / LG Corp:** LG Chem Q3 vs consensus; DART confirmation of PRS terms.
- **Taekwang (003240):** EGM convocation or court filing after Oct 3 (DART).
- **Samsung C&T:** consolidated Q3 (₩1.14tn vs ~₩1tn).
- **Unsearched / unreachable:** about 30 small and mid caps need a per-ticker pass; allowing kabutan.jp, kabuyoho.jp, release.tdnet.info, dart.fss.or.kr, boj.or.jp, mof.go.jp and company IR hosts would fix most gaps.